PRE-BIBLE PITCH SHEET

Airdate: **Wednesday, Nov 18, 2026** (F2, tapes Fri Nov 13) · **One story** (producer, 11/11): a longer A, holiday travel scams, built to stay useful for seven weeks of holiday travel · Prepared Wed, Nov 11, 2026 · Audience 55+.

THE SHORTLIST — RANKED

#	Story	Lead title	Clip (with link)
1	**THE AIRLINE SCAMS THAT CAN STRAND YOU THIS HOLIDAY**	The NEW Airline Scam — DON'T Google THIS Before You Fly!	TikTok, Frontier fake-refund email, 151K+ (per BroBible, Nov 7) · ABC15 fake American Airlines agent (page video) · WPLG, $27K luggage thieves at MIA

HOW THIS WAS BUILT: the producer set the theme and gave the Frontier article and an Instagram reel. I searched each way a holiday traveler gets hit (phone, email, booking, airport, hotel, road), 2025 to Nov 2026, kept only cases with a dated, named source, and checked our coverage since March. Six angles made the show; the stories-inside-the-story page has all of them, with what's in and what's out.

SLATE FIT: Fills the show, with one caveat the room should hear first. It has a villain, a 55+ target (one case is six travelers in their 70s and 80s; another is a couple from The Villages, FL), a real loss to lead with ($7,000, a family stranded in Cancun), a fresh peg (Frontier's warning, Nov 2, ABC7 today), and a fix every viewer can do on their phone tonight. **The caveat: travel is our weakest theme** (0.6x; our hotel-fee and Hertz videos did 3K and 1.6K). The one travel title that worked was fear-first ("Airport Thieves Are WATCHING YOU," 227K). So the title must sell the scam, not "travel." **Clip heat is unconfirmed:** YouTube blocked every view count from here, so no clip clears the viral bar on paper yet.

1. THE AIRLINE SCAMS THAT CAN STRAND YOU THIS HOLIDAY

Status: READY (needs a clip check) · RETURNING THEME, last full travel-scam show early 2026 (60K) · **Score:** 10/14 (Fear 2, Heat 1, Track record 0, Breadth 2, Peg 2, Newness 1, Producibility 2) · **Lead test:** 2 of 3

POTENTIAL PACKAGING

- The NEW Airline Scam — DON'T Google THIS Before You Fly!
- If You Get THIS Email From Your Airline — DON'T Click It!
- Your Flight Is CANCELED? It's a TRAP — They STEAL Your Holiday Trip

Built on: "Airport Thieves Are WATCHING YOU" (227K, our best travel title); "Don't Delete THIS Email" (467K). No "travel" (0.6x).

THE PITCH

Your flight goes wrong, you Google the airline's number or ask Google's AI, and the "agent" who answers charges you to fix it, or logs in and cancels your real flight. Frontier just warned that fake emails carry real names and confirmation codes. Eight days before Thanksgiving, every viewer can check where the airline number in their phone came from.

CASES

- **Omaha family, stranded in Cancun (reported June 2026).** A searched-for number; a fake agent said "all your four tickets are on standby." They paid **$7,000** for a "refundable" fix. Gone. *IBTimes UK, June 5, 2026, citing WOWT.* CHECK: get the WOWT original.
- **Boston (July 2026; published Oct 27).** Booking for six travelers in their 70s and 80s, a woman called a number from Google; her card company stopped a **$4,500** charge. Google's AI served scam numbers planted on hacked sites, including The Villages, FL. *The Points Guy, Oct 27, 2026.*
- **River Forest, IL (July 2026).** A fake Icelandair "agent" logged into her account, charged about **$4,000** and canceled her real reservation. *ABC7 Chicago, July 23.*
- **Frontier (Nov 2, 2026).** "An active email phishing campaign"; a fake **$387.90** refund. *ABC7 KGO, Nov 11.*

> **CLIP** — TikTok, @jayayers3, 151K+ views (per BroBible, Nov 7, 2026), the fake Frontier refund email · ABC15 page video (fake American agent, $2,020) · WPLG, $27K luggage thieves at MIA
> *Not watched — no timecode, no outcue. No YouTube view count or upload date confirmed (bot wall, two tries). TikTok is a manual pull.*

COVERAGE CHECK

Never a fake-number or booking-site segment. Close: miles theft (Aug 26), Turo damage (Oct 21), our older $17,000 airline video. Checked transcripts, titles, Drive to 11/11.

FOOTAGE WE NEED

- **The get:** the Omaha family's WOWT or KSTP package; then ABC15, ABC7 Chicago, the Frontier TikTok, WPLG at MIA. **Demo:** Jeff asks Google's AI for an airline's number live, then finds the real one in the app.

THE PAYOFF

- **Get the airline's number from its app, your confirmation email or your boarding pass. Never from Google or an AI answer.**
- No real airline charges you to fix its cancellation or send a refund (ABC15; Frontier). Check your confirmation code in the airline's app; pay by credit card (BBB, Nov 9).

THE STORIES INSIDE THE STORY

Each angle, with what it adds and whether it's in the show. The outline puts them in this order. Jeff's 11/04 notes: open on the biggest real loss, give each case its own tell, and hold the step-by-step fix for the payoff.

1. THE NUMBER YOU GOOGLED — Omaha, $7,000 (IN, the open: the real loss)

Stranded after a week in Cancun, they called the number a search gave them; "your tickets are on standby," pay $7,000 now, refunded later. It never came. **Adds:** the loss and the holiday-trip fear in one story. **Tell:** anyone who wants money to fix the airline's problem. Clip: not yet found; candidate BwmVMm4M2X0 (outlet and subject unconfirmed). Backup lead: Phoenix, $2,020, ABC15 (on-camera victim, page video).

2. NOW GOOGLE'S AI CAN HAND YOU THE NUMBER — Boston (IN: the 2026 development)

Booking for six travelers in their 70s and 80s, she Googled the airline and called the number shown. The Points Guy then found Google's AI handing out scam lines, one labeled the "primary US escalation line." The fake numbers were planted on hacked university, government and clinic pages, and on The Villages' own website. **Adds:** what's new, and it's aimed squarely at our viewer. Google says its protections are "highly effective" and removed the pages flagged. No news clip; the Jeff demo carries it.

3. THEY LOG IN AND CANCEL YOUR REAL FLIGHT — River Forest, IL (IN: the extended threat)

The fake agent didn't just take $4,000; he canceled her real reservation. **Adds:** the threat goes from your money to your trip (stranded at the gate on Thanksgiving). She got the $4,000 back through her card company (a tell, not a payout story: call the card company fast). ABC7 Chicago.

4. THE EMAIL THAT KNOWS YOUR TRIP — Frontier (IN: the peg)

Real names, real six-character confirmation codes, a fake $387.90 refund; Frontier says it never emails asking for payment or reservation details. **Adds:** the peg and the "but it had my real info" fear. No victims or losses reported. Frontier hasn't said how scammers got the details: say exactly that, never "breach." Clip: the @jayayers3 TikTok (151K+), manual pull.

5. YOU PAID, BUT THERE'S NO TICKET — fake booking sites (IN)

The Villages couple ($11,975.63, 14 tickets, 3 issued; paid 2024); a Dallas family's "Fly-n-Fare" tickets flagged by Frontier ($2,500, FOX 4, Sept 2025, video); BBB warnings Nov 9 and 10, 2026. **Adds:** the check every viewer can do (the confirmation code in the airline's app). Clip: FOX 4 page video or BBB's Local 3 0:40.

6. THE THIEF AT THE CAROUSEL — Miami International (IN: the caught-on-camera beat)

Deputies say surveillance caught a 68-year-old repeatedly going through bags (Aug 2026), and two men taking $27,205 in luggage (April thefts, charged July). **Adds:** the visual and our proven airport-thief lane. Not a scam: keep it short, near the end, with the carousel tips. LEGAL: accused, not convicted.

7. FAKE "HELP" ACCOUNTS THAT ANSWER YOUR COMPLAINT (OPTION, JEFF LINE)

Check Point (a security company), Sept 16, 2026: thousands of fake airline support accounts reply to complaints on X, Facebook and Instagram and dangle "$500 compensation." No U.S. victim, no clip. One Jeff line in case 1.

8. THE "GREAT DEALS" TRAVEL AGENT (OPTION, OR CUT)

SC/GA: an agent accused of taking $10,765 she never booked, paid by Venmo (WTOC, Oct 12). Omaha: 110 customers filed with the FBI, no charges (WOWT, Oct 22). Skews younger (Disney, baseball); no clip. Cut unless the room wants a sixth case.

9. QUICK HITS FOR THE PAYOFF (JEFF LINES)

Toll texts on the drive (about 90% of Thanksgiving travelers drive, AAA 2025); the hotel "front desk" call asking for your card; fake pizza menus under the door. Real, but no 2026 case for any of them.

10. OUT

Booking.com "re-verify your card" messages (no U.S. victim; may repeat Aug 19's booking-site breach). Grandchild "stranded at the airport" (no case found). Airline miles theft (Aug 26). Turo damage (Oct 21). The $17,000 United/Lufthansa case (our older video). Home burglary while away (11/11).

RESEARCH SOURCES & VERIFICATION FLAGS

READ THIS FIRST

- **I cannot watch video.** Clips are described from titles, pages and articles only. No timecodes or outcues here.
- **YouTube blocked every per-video lookup** (Nov 11, two tries 13 minutes apart). No YouTube view count or upload date is confirmed; ages are from the search index. NBC6's MIA clip came back "not available in your country," so check it plays in the U.S. edit.
- **The Instagram reel the producer sent** (Dbs_h8yDoyy) **could not load** (login wall). I haven't guessed what's in it. Someone needs to watch it and tell us where it fits.
- TikTok refuses requests from here: the @jayayers3 clip is a manual pull, and its views come from BroBible, not TikTok.
- No AAA or TSA Thanksgiving 2026 forecast had been published as of Nov 11. Check again Thursday before taping.
- Full case file: research_travel.md.

STORY 1 — THE AIRLINE SCAMS THAT CAN STRAND YOU

Confirmed:

- Omaha: Anitha (surname withheld) couldn't check in after a week in Cancun, searched for the airline's number, was told "all your four tickets are on standby," paid $7,000 to be refunded later, never was. At the airport, the tickets had never been on standby. Airline not named. BBB's Josh Planos and Celebrate Travel's Donna Dutcher quoted (IBTimes UK, June 5, 2026, citing WOWT).
- Phoenix: "Cher" reached an American Airlines impostor after a cancellation; paid $1,010 to rebook, then was told to pay $1,010 more to get a $2,020 refund. ABC15: "You should never have to pay money to receive a refund" (ABC15, undated page, mid-2026; Simple Flying, July 9, 2026).
- River Forest, IL: an email about an Icelandair change led to a "live chat" with a phone number; the man logged in, charged about $4,000 for "flexible" tickets and canceled the real reservation. AmEx refunded the $4,000 after the I-Team stepped in; about $2,000 for the original tickets was not recovered (ABC7 Chicago, July 23, 2026).
- Boston: Marcia Hannon, booking for six travelers in their 70s and 80s, called a number from a Google search; AmEx stopped a $4,500 charge. The Points Guy found Google AI Mode and AI Overviews giving scam numbers, planted on hacked pages including The Villages, FL and the City of Freeport, TX. Google: "Our anti-spam protections are highly effective at keeping scams out of our features"; flagged pages removed (The Points Guy, Michelle Couch-Friedman, Oct 27, 2026; Travel Noire, Oct 30).
- Frontier: "We are aware of an active email phishing campaign targeting our customers"; "Frontier Airlines does not email customers requesting flight, reservation, payment or contact detail information." Emails carry real names, six-character confirmation codes and itineraries; one offered a $387.90 refund (NBC10, Nov 2; TravelersToday, Nov 4; ABC7 KGO, Nov 11, 2026; flyfrontier.com/phishing-awareness). Frontier: 801-401-9000.
- The Villages, FL: George and Diana Franco paid $11,975.63 for 14 Punta Cana tickets; 3 were issued. Delta: booked by "a fraudulent third party who had no ticketing authority." Paid March 2024; story updated June 28, 2026 (WESH 2).
- Dallas: two cousins lost $2,500 through "Fly-n-Fare"; Frontier flagged the tickets; BBB rates it F (FOX 4, Sept 25, 2025).
- BBB warnings on third-party booking sites: Local 3 News, Nov 9, 2026 (0:40 video); KPRC, Nov 10, 2026 (Leah Napoliello, BBB Greater Houston).
- AARP: the FTC got more than 64,000 reports of travel, vacation and timeshare fraud in 2025 (AARP, updated Apr 24, 2026).

Sources: ibtimes.co.uk Omaha · ABC15 Phoenix · Simple Flying · ABC7 Chicago · The Points Guy · Travel Noire · ABC7 KGO Frontier · NBC10 Frontier · TravelersToday · BroBible (TikTok) · Frontier phishing page · WESH 2 · FOX 4 Dallas · WRTV · Local 3 BBB · KPRC BBB · Local 10, MIA $27K · Local 10, MIA carousel · Check Point · WTOC · WOWT · AARP travel scams · BBB 2025 older-adults report

NEEDS VERIFICATION:

- **The open rests on a secondary source.** The Omaha $7,000 case comes through IBTimes UK quoting WOWT; I couldn't load the WOWT original or find its clip. This is the cold open: get the WOWT/KSTP story and video, or lead with Phoenix (ABC15, on camera, $2,020) instead.
- **"They log in and cancel your real flight" is the sexiest line, and one case supports it** (River Forest). Say "in one case," not "they cancel your flight."
- **"Google's AI gave her the scam number":** The Points Guy found AI answers serving scam numbers, but its Boston traveler is described as Googling and calling the number shown. Keep the two apart on air unless TPG says her number came from the AI answer.
- **Frontier: never say "breach."** Frontier disclosed a customer-care database incident to the Massachusetts AG (Oct 2, 2026), and a class action alleges incidents in May and June, but Frontier hasn't linked either to the emails (TravelersToday). Say "Frontier hasn't said how scammers got those details."
- **The 60+ travel-loss number:** secondary coverage of the FTC's Oct 19, 2026 report to Congress says people 60+ lost $45 million to travel and vacation fraud in 2025, up 27% (ppc.land). Check it against the FTC PDF before Jeff says it.
- **A McAfee survey** (vendor) says 1 in 3 travelers hit a travel scam; snippets only, the press page returned 503. Attribute it as "a McAfee survey" or drop it.
- **Don't cite "a record 122 million holiday travelers"** (KPRC, Nov 10): it's AAA's 2025 year-end number. Thanksgiving 2025 was 81.8 million (AAA). Use the 2026 figure when it comes out.
- Boston: no money was lost (the card company stopped it). Use it for "it nearly happened," not as a loss.
- The Villages couple paid in 2024. Date it on air.
- Miami: the article bodies didn't load; names and charges come from search snippets of Local 10 and CubaHeadlines. Accused, not convicted.
- Delta's "add your record locator to your account" tip comes through a secondary site (ANF, Aug 11, 2026). Confirm with Delta or say "check the airline's app."
- "Forward scam texts to 7726 (SPAM)" is widely published guidance; confirm before air.
- The AirTag-in-the-bag tip: confirm the current carrier and TSA guidance on trackers in checked bags (lithium battery rules).

STORIES CUT — SOURCING PRESERVED

- Booking.com "re-verify your card" messages: the pattern is confirmed in UK/EU reports; secondary sources (IdentityIQ, June 18, 2026) say Booking.com confirmed unauthorized access Apr 13–14, 2026. No U.S. victim found. Check whether Aug 19's "booking-site breach" was this.
- Denver, Dan Smoker, $17,328: a United agent transferred him to a scam "Lufthansa" number from Google (9NEWS, Aug 2025). Almost certainly our "THIS Airline Scam Cost Him $17,000!" Don't reuse it.
- Raleigh, NC, the Lamotta family, more than $13,000 after a fake "complication with your reservation" number (ABC11, Nov 11, 2025). A backup case for item 1, a year old.
- Goshen, IN grandfather, $400 to a "flight specials" site, recovered by card dispute (WRTV, June 2026, page video). Small loss.
- A fake Lufthansa number from a sponsored ad cost a traveler $12,000+ (WSJ via ConsumerAffairs, May 2026). Snippet only.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE MEETING

- **Title: sell the scam or the season?** Travel is our weakest theme, so I'd keep "travel" out of the title and put the holiday in the thumbnail and description. "DON'T Google THIS Before You Fly" vs. "If You Get THIS Email From Your Airline."
- **The open: Omaha ($7,000, no clip yet) or Phoenix ($2,020, on camera)?** Jeff's note says biggest real loss first. That's Omaha, if Kyle can find the WOWT or KSTP package by Thursday.
- **The Instagram reel:** what is it, and where does it go? I couldn't open it.
- **The demo:** Jeff Googles an airline's customer service number and asks Google's AI on camera. If a scam number comes up, that's the moment of the show. Who sets it up and screen-records it?
- **Guest:** Amy Nofziger (AARP, our audience), or The Points Guy's Michelle Couch-Friedman (she found the AI-search numbers)? Neither is booked.
- **The carousel thieves:** keep as the caught-on-camera beat near the end, or cut it to stay scams-only?
- **Thanksgiving numbers:** AAA and TSA usually publish the week before. Does Kyle grab them Thursday for the open?